

Objective sheet

Name the objective, minutes 2–7

Seven rows that turn a business goal into a learning problem. Derive the ML objective from the decision the model makes, not from the prompt's metric. Name what the proxy cannot see and guard it. Nothing about a model yet.

Brief restated in one sentence; the decision the model exists to make	
Business objective what the business is charged by; how it is measured	
ML objective per what unit, predicting what, given what is known when	
Offline proxy the metric at the operating point, on which slice, on which split	
Online proxy the fast read and the slow read; the unit of randomisation	
Guardrails what the proxy cannot see, on the same page as the proxy	
Allowed to get wrong freely / rarely / never; the “never” is a rule, not a probability	
Not an ML problem the walls, filters, rules and processes the model does not decide	

Envelope

Bound the problem, minutes 7–13

One significant figure. A day is 10^5 seconds. Propose the numbers and say where you expect to be corrected. Compute cost in core-seconds, accelerator-seconds or tokens per thousand, never in a price; Appendix A has the reference figures. The last line is the point.

Rate requests per second at peak; items scored per request; rows or events per day	
Latency budget end to end at the percentile named, split by stage; first token if generative	
Labelled data where the label comes from, how late, how biased, what it cannot see; the randomised slice	
Freshness by tier: streaming features / hourly / nightly; model cadence, set by the label's delay	
Stored online store, vectors and index, served-feature log for the label delay, weights and cache	
Cost per thousand: core-s, accelerator-s or tokens; batched or not; the term that dominates; own or rent by utilisation	
Cold start new user, new item, new category: what is served and from where	
Binds the one line that decides the design, and why the others do not; the line that binds next	

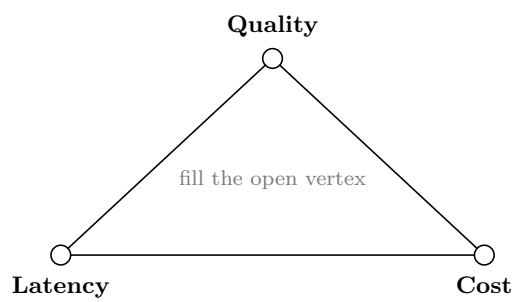
Tradeoff table

Choose under the constraint, minutes 15–18

Three to six rows. Write the ends in the brief’s own terms. The last column names which way this brief points, which line of the envelope does the pushing, and the price. Then fill the triangle: two vertices fixed by the brief, the third solved for.

Axis	One end	Other end	Which way, why, and the price

Budget triangle open vertex: solved for



Quality: _____
fixed by _____ / solved

Latency: _____
fixed by _____ / solved

Cost: _____
fixed by _____ / solved

Freshness (fourth axis): _____

Decision line

Choose, minutes 18–21

One boxed sentence with three parts, then the diagram drawn as its consequence with the envelope's numbers on the arrows. "I am choosing X over Y, because the brief weights A above B, and I accept C." The model is a position on the quality–latency edge with a cost, not a name.

I am choosing	over
because	
I accept	

The diagram at minute fifteen

drawn after the decision line; every arrow carries a number from the envelope; the model is one box with its size and its cost

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Loop sheet

Close the loop, minutes 35–43

Five rows, written before the metric is read. The shipping rule goes in the second row before the test runs. The feedback row says what the model does to its own data. Harm has a measurement by group and a rollback with a clock.

Before shipping the suite by slice; the golden set; the guardrails; the time-ordered split	
After shipping the canary; the A/B by unit and its length; the slow read; the shipping rule, written now	
Silent failures nulls, lag, lost state, a drifting judge, a cache older than its TTL: what fails with no alarm	
Feedback what the model does to its own labels; what users or adversaries learn; how it is seen	
Harm and rollback errors by group; what is versioned separately; what reverts on which clock; the irreversible step	

Timing sheet The mock protocol, Chapter 15

The partner holds this. Write the minute each artefact was complete and the minute the candidate first named a model. At the end the candidate writes their own guesses in the last column before seeing the sheet; the gap is the measure.

Artefact	Plan (45)	Plan (60)	Actual	Candidate's guess / notes
Brief restated	2	2		
Objective sheet complete	7	8		
Envelope complete	13	15		
Binding sentence said	15	17		
First model named	≥ 15	≥ 17		
Tradeoff table and triangle	18	21		
Decision line	20	23		
Diagram finished	21	24		
Mechanism worked (which?)	35	36		
Second mechanism (60 only)	—	47		
Loop sheet started	35	50		
Loop sheet complete	43	58		
Close delivered	45	60		

Pushes delivered and what happened conceded and priced / defended / return edge named

Self-scoring sheet

The rubric of Chapter 16

Score each row below, at or above the bar, from the anchors in Chapter 16; the partner scores separately and the two sheets are compared row by row. Mark the row that decides this brief first: if it is below the bar the design is below the bar. Note any red flag from Section 16.5 at the foot.

Row	Below	At	Above	The sentence quoted, or what was missing
Objective				
Bound				
Binds				
Choose				
Deepen was it the binding part?				
Close the loop				
Recovery				
Row that decides this brief				
Red flags				
Decision hire / no hire, with the row quoted				